

StarPower (603290.SS): Industrial and Power semis to support growth; Expanding AI power product coverage

We remain positive on StarPower's product mix upgrade and end-market diversification, supported by (1) solid demand from industrial and power-supply applications, (2) the company's product expansion into AI power applications across high-voltage SiC/IGBT and low-voltage GaN/MOSFET/DrMOS solutions, and (3) the continued commercialization of SiC products and development of MCU and GaN products. StarPower's industrial control and power-supply revenue grew 40% YoY to Rmb710mn in 1H26, partially offsetting weaker demand from new-energy applications. We expect StarPower's revenues to grow by 22% / 15% QoQ to Rmb1,293mn / Rmb1,484mn in 3Q26E / 4Q26E. While the company's broader product portfolio could support its longer-term growth, we remain cautious on its near-term earnings outlook, considering raw material tight supply and ongoing price competition along with new products investment, which could slow the margin recovery. Maintain Neutral on fair valuation.

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AI power products to broaden applications: StarPower is expanding from automotive and industrial applications into AI power infrastructure, covering high-voltage power conversion for solid-state transformers with SiC and IGBT products, as well as lower-voltage power supply applications with GaN, MOSFET and DrMOS products. We believe this broader coverage could increase the company's addressable applications and product content across different power-conversion stages.

SiC to lead near-term commercialization: StarPower's new products are at different ramp-up stages, with SiC making the strongest commercial progress. Its automotive SiC modules are already in volume shipment for 400V–1,000V platforms, while its three-level SiC modules have secured design wins and are expected to enter mass production in 2027E. In comparison, the company expects its main-drive MCU to begin small-volume shipments by end-2026E, while automotive GaN modules are targeted for volume production in 2028E.

Earnings revision: We keep our 2026E–28E revenue estimates unchanged, while revising down our GM estimates by 1.2ppts / 1.6ppts / 2.5ppts, considering raw material tight supply and ongoing price competition. Nevertheless, we continue to expect the GM to increase through 2028, driven by larger revenues scale to drive efficiency along with product mix upgrade. With our opex ratio estimates largely unchanged, our 2026E–28E NI estimates are revised down by 13% / 12% / 18%.

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Exhibit 1: Earnings revision

(Rmb mn)	2026E			2027E			2028E		
	New	Old	Diff	New	Old	Diff	New	Old	Diff
Revenue	4,705	4,705	0%	5,932	5,932	0%	6,551	6,551	0%
Gross profit	1,040	1,097	-5%	1,414	1,506	-6%	1,589	1,752	-9%
Operating income	335	392	-14%	617	710	-13%	717	880	-19%
Net income	364	419	-13%	639	730	-12%	731	889	-18%
Margins									
Gross margin	22.1%	23.3%	-1.2ppts	23.8%	25.4%	-1.6ppts	24.3%	26.7%	-2.5ppts
Operating margin	7.1%	8.3%	-1.2ppts	10.4%	12.0%	-1.6ppts	10.9%	13.4%	-2.5ppts
Net margin	7.7%	8.9%	-1.2ppts	10.8%	12.3%	-1.5ppts	11.2%	13.6%	-2.4ppts

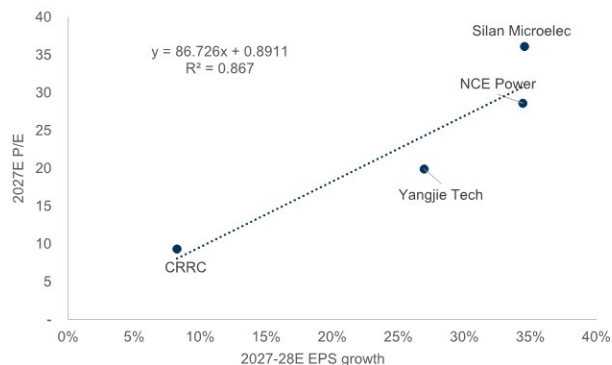
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: StarPower P&L summary

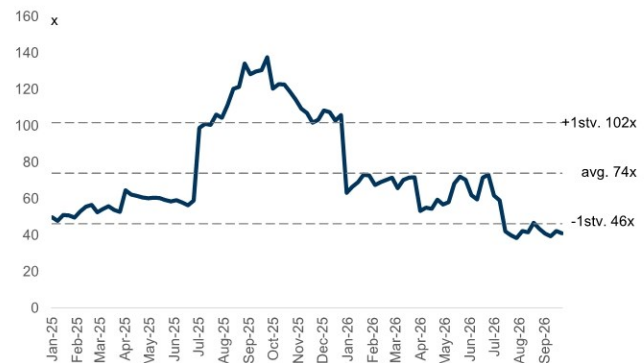
(Rmb m)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	919	1,016	1,054	1,023	864	1,064	1,293	1,484	2,705	3,663	3,391	4,012	4,705	5,932	6,551
Gross profit	279	296	259	212	182	215	301	343	1,090	1,374	1,070	1,047	1,040	1,414	1,589
Operating income	99	158	92	6	18	36	124	158	788	956	563	356	335	617	717
Net income	104	172	106	23	27	38	131	169	818	911	508	405	364	639	731
EPS (Rmb)	0.43	0.72	0.44	0.10	0.11	0.16	0.55	0.70	4.79	5.33	2.12	1.69	1.52	2.67	3.05
Margins / ratio															
Gross margin	30.4%	29.2%	24.5%	20.8%	21.1%	20.2%	23.3%	23.1%	40.3%	37.5%	31.6%	26.1%	22.1%	23.8%	24.3%
Opex ratio	-19.6%	-13.7%	-15.8%	-20.2%	-19.0%	-16.8%	-13.7%	-12.5%	-11.2%	-11.4%	-14.9%	-17.2%	-15.0%	-13.4%	-13.3%
Operating margin	10.8%	15.5%	8.8%	0.6%	2.0%	3.4%	9.6%	10.6%	29.1%	26.1%	16.6%	8.9%	7.1%	10.4%	10.9%
Net margin	13.7%	18.2%	10.7%	1.9%	3.2%	4.7%	10.4%	11.7%	34.3%	28.5%	17.9%	11.0%	8.2%	11.1%	11.6%
QoQ															
Revenue	-6%	11%	4%	-3%	-16%	23%	22%	15%							
Gross profit	-8%	6%	-13%	-18%	-14%	18%	40%	14%							
Operating income	-20%	58%	-41%	-93%	182%	107%	240%	28%							
Net income	23%	66%	-38%	-78%	14%	44%	240%	29%							
EPS	23%	66%	-38%	-78%	14%	44%	240%	29%							
YoY															
Revenue	14%	40%	20%	5%	-6%	5%	23%	45%	59%	35%	-7%	18%	17%	26%	10%
Gross profit	9%	30%	-8%	-30%	-35%	-28%	16%	62%	74%	26%	-22%	-2%	-1%	36%	12%
Operating income	-40%	51%	-45%	-95%	-82%	-77%	34%	2439%	82%	21%	-41%	-37%	-6%	84%	16%
Net income	-36%	53%	-28%	-72%	-74%	-78%	23%	622%	105%	11%	-44%	-20%	-10%	75%	14%
EPS	-36%	53%	-28%	-72%	-74%	-78%	23%	622%	93%	11%	-60%	-20%	-10%	75%	14%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation: We continue to use near-term P/E to derive our 12-month target price. Our 2027E target P/E remains broadly unchanged at 39.8x (vs. 39.9x previously), based on peers' forward trading P/E and net income growth. With our lower earnings estimates, our 12-month target price is lowered to Rmb106.3 (vs. Rmb121.2 previously). **Maintain Neutral.**

Exhibit 3: StarPower local and global peers' 2027 P/E and 27-28E earnings growth

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Refinitiv Eikon

Exhibit 4: StarPower: 12m forward P/E

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - StarPower

Valuation methodology: We are Neutral rated on StarPower with a 12-month target

price of **Rmb106.3**. We apply a 39.8x target P/E multiple to our 2027E EPS. Our target P/E multiple is derived from the sector's P/E-EPS YoY growth correlation.

Key risks: 1) Stronger-/weaker-than-expected IGBT market growth, 2) Faster-/slower-than-expected new design wins and market share gains, 3) new product development progressing faster/slower than expected, and 4) less/more competition.

603290.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb106.30	Price: Rmb81.21	Upside: 30.9%
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Neutral	GS Forecast				
Market cap: Rmb19.4bn / \$2.9bn Enterprise value: Rmb19.9bn / \$3.0bn 3m ADTV: Rmb808.1mn / \$119.6mn China Greater China Technology M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	4,012.4	4,704.6	5,932.4	6,550.8
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	805.7	1,297.9	1,602.0	1,718.2
	EPS (Rmb) New	1.69	1.52	2.67	3.05
	EPS (Rmb) Old	1.69	1.75	3.05	3.71
	P/E (X)	54.4	53.4	30.4	26.6
	P/B (X)	3.2	2.7	2.5	2.4
	Dividend yield (%)	0.6	0.6	1.0	1.1
	CROCI (%)	12.8	14.7	16.4	15.5
		6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.16	0.55	0.70	0.42

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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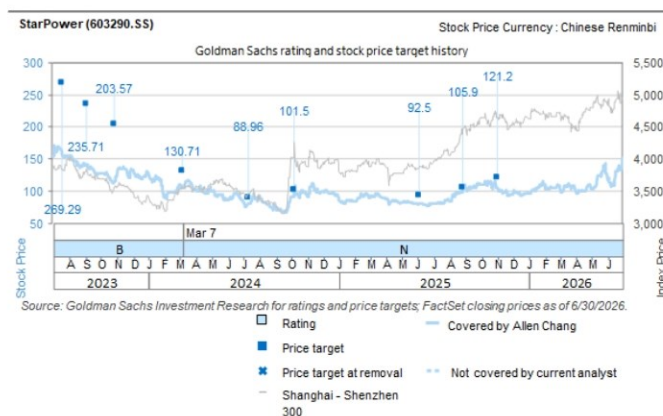
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Target price history table(s)

StarPower (603290.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
02-Nov-25	121.20	104.58
28-Aug-25	105.90	108.04
05-Jun-25	92.50	81.30
08-Oct-24	101.50	100.38
11-Jul-24	88.96	80.32
07-Mar-24	183.00	104.71
27-Oct-23	285.00	115.09

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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